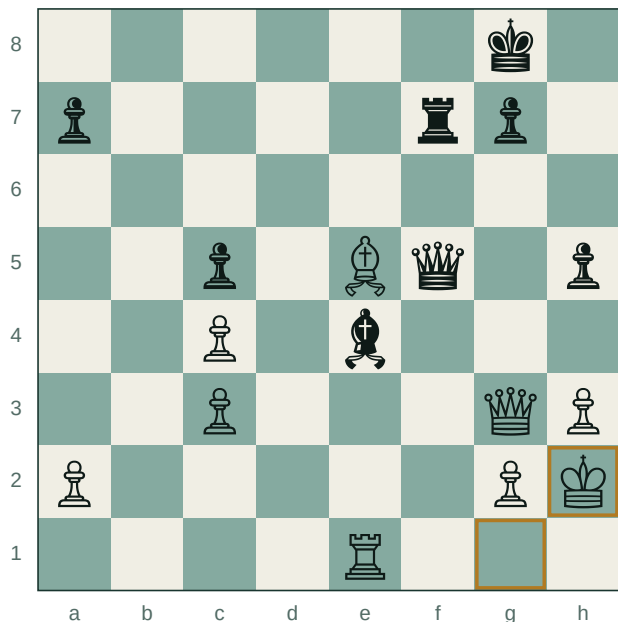


Deflection tactics: Black, move 30

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 30.Kh2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30...h4 31. Qxh4 Qxe5+

30...h4 The pawn moves from h5 to h4. Recorded reply: **31.Qxh4**.

31...Qxe5+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on h2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.